

Practice Problems #17

1. True or False. Justify your answer.

Let $V = \mathbf{R}^2$, which we showed is a vector space with the usual operations

$$u + v = (u_1 + v_1, u_2 + v_2), \quad cu = (cu_1, cu_2).$$

Then,

$$H = \{(x, y) : xy \leq 0\},$$

is a subspace of V .

2. Show $c0 = 0$ for every scalar c following the proof below. Justify each step.

Proof: $c0 = c(0 + 0) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}} + \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

Then,

$$0 = -c0 + c0 = (-c0 + c0) + \underline{\hspace{2cm}} = 0 + c0 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}.$$

3. For $u \in V$, where V is a vector space, suppose

$$\alpha u = 0$$

for some nonzero scalar α . Show that $u = 0$. Justify each and every step in your proof.

Hints or Answers are on the next page.

#1: False. Why?

#2: Mimic what we did in class.

#3: Note that $u = 1u$ (which axiom?). Use the result from #2.